by a democratically-elected government, the core imperatives of South Africa remain the maintenance of a liberal regime that permits the free flow of labour and capital to and from the southern Africa region, as well as the maintenance of a superior security capability able to project into south-central Africa.'

However, South African capital's ability to move up-continent was thrown into question in March 2013, in the Central African Republic capital of Bangui after authoritarian ruler François Bozizé was ousted by guerrillas. More than a dozen South African soldiers were killed, according to interviews with surviving troops in Johannesburg's main Sunday newspaper, while 'protecting belongings of … businesses in Jo'burg ... We were lied to straight out ... We were told we were here to serve and protect, to ensure peace' (Hosken and Mahlangu 2013). The protected Johannesburg capitalists included firms linked to the ruling African National Congress party (ANC) (Amabhungane 2013). After the fiasco involving a couple of hundred troops in Bangui, in 2014 more than 1500 troops were deployed in the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo replete with advanced fighter helicopters. Not far away, President Jacob Zuma's nephew Khulubuse had suspiciously acquired a US$10 billion oil concession, and other South African firms (even Anglo American) were embarrassed by ties to warlords. At least five million people have been killed in this mineral-rich Great Lakes region since South Africa won democracy in 1994.

Dynamics of imperialism and sub-imperialism

These latter relationships, in which capitalism both exploits and corrodes non-capitalist relations through extra-economic coercive techniques, yet also maintains them through imperial power relations, were theorised originally by Rosa Luxemburg. They have been revitalised as an explanatory system by David Harvey under the rubric of accumulation by dispossession. In other words, there are theoretically derived processes which explain the logic of imperialism and sub-imperialism together, even if contingencies may change the metabolisms and the geographical places, shapes and scales within which these processes unfold.

Luxemburg's (1968:396) *Accumulation of Capital* focuses on how capitalism's extra-economic coercive capacities draw surpluses not just from formal capital–labour productive relations but also from families (especially women's role in social reproduction), the land, all forms of nature, mutual aid systems and what we have come to know as the 'commons', and the shrinking state: 'The relations between capitalism and the non-capitalist modes of production start making their appearance on the international stage. Its predominant methods are colonial policy, an international loan system – a policy of spheres of interest – and war.